

Petition for Dark Souls on PC

Namco Bandai, the company behind the game will make a PC port of the game if there are enough petitioners
<http://bit.ly/xMF2wL>

USB 3.0 on tablets and phones

USB 3.0 to get a slimmer form factor enabling adoption tablets and phones
<http://bit.ly/y8da46>

Make your own QR code

Forget those boring black and white QR codes, add some colour and customize your very own hip QR codes

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Quick Response codes or QR codes are slowly but surely becoming mainstream what with every other person sporting a smartphone with a decent camera these days. It is the most convenient way to go from an offline to an online experience. You just have to focus your phone camera on the QR code and you're automatically taken to the QR code's embedded destination (mostly a hyperlink).

Nine out of ten times, you'll notice a QR code in its black and white avatar and this could be boring. So can you really change that colour combination? Add your personal touch to a QR code?

Yes, you can.

In this tutorial, we'll show you how you can change the colour of your QR



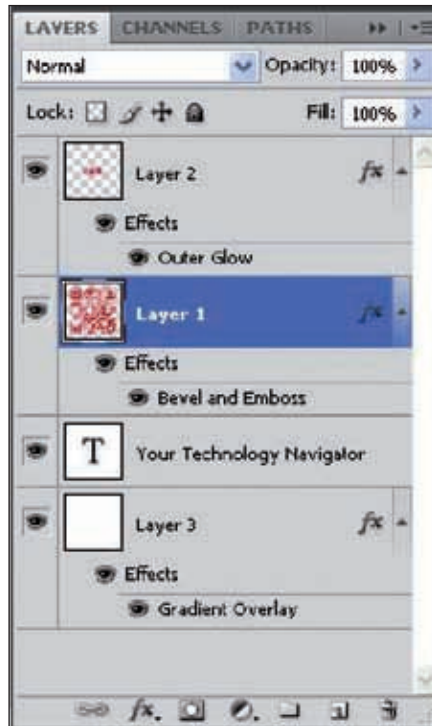
Original QR code with black color



Original QR code changed to red color

code, add a personal logo bang in the middle of the code and even smoothen the sharp edges of the squares and rectangles that comprises of the QR code.

There are many web sites such as <http://goqr.me/> to help you generate your QR code. You can program the QR codes to lead the scanner to a URL, phone number, text or even a visiting card. We decided to stick to the URL of our web site: www.thinkdigit.com



You can even apply an emboss effect

Select the URL tab on the QR code generating web site and enter the URL: <http://thinkdigit.com>

Move the slider alongside to a size of 300x300px. Under "Options" select the Error Correction Code as Q. You can change the Data Pixel colour to one that you like from its swatch. Though there's no rule saying that the background must be white, there has to be a strong contrast between the background and the code for the phone camera to be able to scan it easily.

Once the QR code is generated, all you need to do is download the file for further editing. You can use any advanced image editing program.



Embossed image



With the Digit logo

We used Photoshop, and here's what we did. We first opened a layer and superimposed the QR code on it. We then unchecked the background layer, leaving us with the white background of the QR code. To remove it, you need to convert the image to a Smart Object. Then click **Select** menu > **Color Range** and keeping all things constant select the white colour and hit delete. Now you'll just get the QR code. Recheck the background layer.

We tried adding an inner embossing on the code, while constantly checking if the QR code is still pointing to the web site, else you need to go slow on the modifications or even undo a few changes, so take care.

We then added the Digit logo in an image layer and gave it an outer glow. It was placed in the centre.

The tricky part was adding a gradient on the background. After a lot of trial and error with different colours, the blue/light blue combo seemed to work for us.

On a text layer we placed "Your Technology Navigator" below the QR code.

Behold! Our final image.



With gradient



Final image - with gradient and tagline

There's so much more you can do with the QR code to personalise it. Google QR code enthusiast, Patrick Donnelly's Farmville design, which he spent months "growing". You can even arrange real-life objects such as music instruments, animals, cartoons, etc into a scannable code. Up to 30 per cent of the QR code image can be removed and replaced with an embedded image while ensuring that the code is still stable. Let your imagination run wild... ■